F 03-09

NON-CONFORMANCE, CORRECTIVE ACTION AND CLEARANCE REPORT

SANAS No.: T1195

Organisation Name: **Azuresky Laboratory**

NC Report Number: **AB07**

Area/Scope Assessed: **Management Requirements**

Assessor / Inspector / Expert: **A. Bougart**

PART 1: DETAILED OBSERVATION

At the time of the assessment, it was observed that Document ASFM 7.16 point 7 states that for all NCs, a risk matrix must be used to evaluate and assess the risk of the NC. The NCW register only has major and minor ratings for all NCs.

Signed (Representative):

Signed (Team Leader / Inspector): A. Bougart

MAJOR: [X] MINOR: [ ]

Reference No. of relevant Guide / Standard / Requirement: **ISO/IEC 17025 requirement 8.7.1 e**

Date: **08/04/2026**

PART 2: ROOT CAUSE ANALYSIS

(Provide an analysis of the extent and cause of the nonconformity)

- Over-complex procedural design since the procedure ASMF 7.17 mandated a full risk matrix evaluation for every NC regardless of its nature. This created a procedural bottleneck where the administrative effort outweighed the technical necessity, leading to inconsistent application of the risk matrix in the NCW register.
- Lack of tiered evaluation since the QMS did not distinguish between low risk human errors and systemic failures high risk; resulting in a failure to perform the mandatory risk assessments as described in the documentation.

PART 3: CORRECTIVE ACTION TAKEN

(Clearly indicate what corrective action was taken, and attach supportig evidence of implementation)

- Procedure ASMF 7.17 has been revised
- Implementation of monitoring period
- Conditional risk assessment.
- NCW Risk Register Updated.

Date: 16/04/26

Signed (Representative): Aponya

PART 4: CORRECTIVE ACTION VERIFIED AND CLEARED

(Comment on whether the corrective action is sufficient and appropriate)

Date:

Signed: Assessor / Inspector/Expert:

PART 5: FOLLOW-UP AT NEXT ASSESSMENT

(Comment on the implementation of the corrective actions)

Date:

Signed: Assessor / Inspector/Expert:

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AS004MF 07/25

BRAINSTORMING FORM

IRQ no: 7307

Brainstorming team

Tshepo Maponya
Sifiso Nyambi
Nosipho Hlongwane
Keitumetse Maleka

What went Wrong?

- The NCW register does not have risk ratings for NCs, despite document ASMF 7.17 stating that a risk matrix must be used all NCs.

Why 1: Why was the risk matrix not used in the register?
> The process of appliying the full risk matrix to every single minor & major NC was found to be creating 'paper work burden' and was frequently skipped by staff because it was time consuming.

Why 2: Why was the process found to be paper work burden/time consuming?
> The procedure required the same level of complex evaluation for simpler low risk NCs as it did for major technical failure NCs.

Why 3: Why did the procedure require the same level of evaluation for all NCs?
- The origional design of doc ASMF 7.17 was too rigid and did not provide a tiered approach or a screening process to determine which NCs actually required a formal risk update.

Why 4: Why was a tiered approach not included in the origional QMS design?
> The laboratory overimplemented the requirement for risk-based thinking, assuming that 'evaluation of risk' meant performing a full matrix calculation for every event, rather than assessing risk only when 'necessary' per the ISO standard.

Why 5:

Reason: Over-complex procedural design
: Lack of tiered evaluation

Supervisor: Maponya

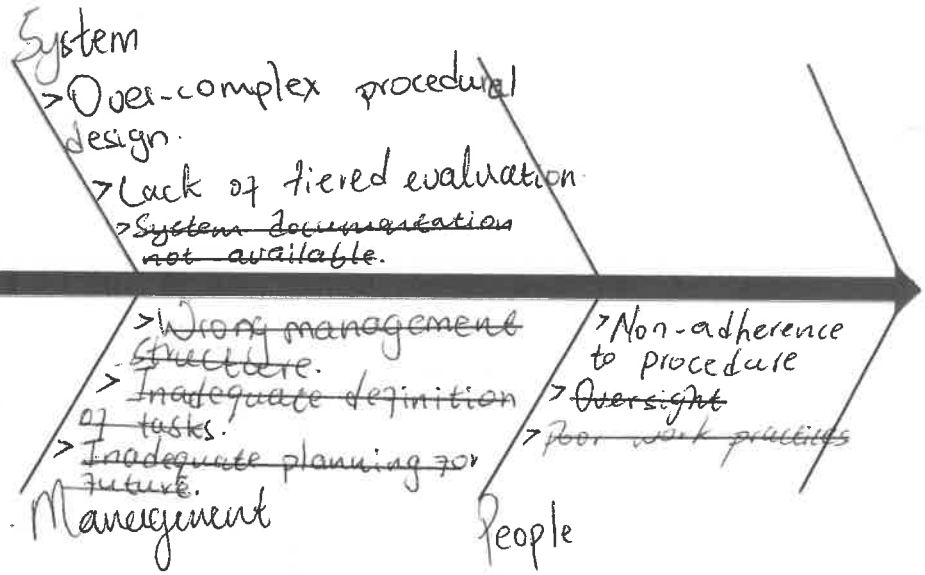
AS001MF

07/25

ROOT CAUSE ANALYSIS FORM

IRQ NO: ABO7

At the time of the assessment, it was observed that document ASMF 7.17 point 7 states that for all NCs, a risk matrix must be used to evaluate and assess the risk of the NC. The NCW register only has major and minor ratings for all NCs.



SUPERVISOR

AS009MF 04/26

Additional Space for NC's

IRQ no: AB07

Part 3: Corrective action taken.

1. Procedure Revision: Document ASMT 7.17 has been revised. The laboratory has moved from a "mandatory for all" risk assessment model to a "performance Based" model.
2. Implementation of Monitoring Period: A formal follow up/monitoring period has been established (1-3 months for Major NCs; 3 to 6 months for minor). During this time, the effectiveness of the initial corrective action is monitored.
3. Conditional Risk Assessment: The procedure now states that if no reoccurrence occurs during the monitoring period, the NC is considered effectively closed without further risk assessment. However, if a recurrence is noted, a mandatory full risk assessment with management is triggered to evaluate potential systemic risks. Document 8.5 Risks & opportunity will be employed in this case.
4. The NCW register has been updated to reflect these new statuses categories (Monitoring Period, ~~Closed~~/Effective. or Triggers Risk assessment).

Supervisor: Mapongya

	MANAGEMENT OF NON-CONFORMING WORK	
AzurESky	Document no: ASMF7.17	
Compiled by:	Sifiso Nyambi - Laboratory Manager	
Approved by:	Nonhlanhla Msibi - Operations Manager	

Role	Responsibility
Operations Manager	Approve final corrective actions and ensure traceability of decisions

4. Identification of non-conformity

Sources may include:
- Observation during routine work or supervision
- Internal audits
- Stability/homogeneity test failures
- Customer complaints
- Out-of-spec test results
- Incorrect CoA's or labelling errors

5. Initial Actions

- Immediately halt use of affected PT or RM/CRM or analysis or process step.
- Label the product or isolate the equipment with "NON-CONFORMING" tags.
- Notify the Laboratory/Operations Manager.
- Use ASMF 8.7.3 or SANAS F03-09 Improvement Action request form.

6. Documentation

The Improvement Action request form shall log the following:
- Unique NCW ID
- Date/time of detection
- Process stage affected
- Description of non-conformance
- Responsible person(s)
- Immediate action taken (containment), If necessary, ensure notification to customers within 24 hours of recording an NCW
- Signature of person reporting

BEFORE

ADDED:
- Root cause(s) identified
- Corrective action(s) taken
- Evidence of implementation
- Planned date for effectiveness review
- Results of effectiveness review
- Date of closure

7. Evaluation and Risk Assessment

Assess whether the non-conformance:
- Affects previously released PT or RMs/CRMs
- Affects previously released reports/work/samples tested
- Requires rework, retesting, or full recall
- Risks invalidating assigned property values or traceability
- Has occurred before (recurring issue)

Use a risk matrix to evaluate severity and urgency.

8. Corrective Actions

Once root cause is confirmed:
- Define the correction and corrective action
- Assign responsible personnel and target dates
- Validate effectiveness after implementation
- Document updates to SOPs, training, or process controls if needed

ADDED:
- Where necessary, changes to the management system (procedures, work instructions, risk registers, or controls) shall be implemented to prevent recurrence of the non-conformance.
- Appropriate corrective actions shall be proportional to the risk and impact of the

BEFORE

non-conforming work.
• All corrective actions shall be traceable to the identified root cause.

• Where necessary:

- Ensure notification of customers and recall CRM's/RM's and certificates and documentation within an appropriate period. This also means that any tested samples which can have a significant impact on the operations of customers shall be relayed to the client.
- PT reports already sent to participants are recalled or disregarded.

9. Follow-Up and Closure

• Verify the corrective action eliminated or mitigated the issue
• Retest or recharacterize RM/CRM/sample batch if necessary
• Document closure with review sign-off from operations/lab manager and resume work.
• Update NCW register and archive all records securely
• A planned Internal Audit must include the checking or evaluate the corrective action taken, this it ensures effectiveness of the implementation

ADDED:
• Effectiveness of corrective actions shall be evaluated after a suitable period of implementation to confirm that the non-conformance has not recurred and that process performance has improved.
• Effectiveness shall be verified by review of subsequent test results, repeat stability or homogeneity testing (where applicable), audit findings, or trend analysis of NCW records.
• The outcome of the effectiveness review shall be recorded on the Improvement Action Request form prior to formal closure of the NCW.

10. Timelines

- Major NCs shall be closed within 24 hours from the time of detection.
- Minor NCs shall be closed within 7 days from the time of detection.

ADDED:
- Effectiveness of corrective actions for **Major NCs** shall be reviewed within **1 to 3 months**, depending on the nature and risk of the non-conformance.
- Effectiveness of corrective actions for **Minor NCs** shall be reviewed within **3 to 6 months** after implementation.
- Where justified by the nature of the non-conformance (e.g. long-term stability, trend monitoring), extended review periods may be defined and documented.

11. Record Retention

- NCW records must be stored for minimum of 10 years, linked to batch records.
- Include them in management review for trend analysis.

ADDED:
- Records shall include the nature of the non-conformance, root cause(s), corrective actions taken, planned and actual effectiveness review dates, and results of effectiveness verification.
- Corrective action records shall be available for verification during internal audits and external assessments.

12. Revision

Revision no	Content changed	Reason for the change	Date
01	Extended the scope of this procedure to ISO 17025, under PURPOSE,SCOPE	Lab expanding to ISO 17025	02/02/2026

Effective date	Rev status	Next review date
02/2026	03	02/2029

4. Identification of non-conformity

Major Nonconformance

A major nonconformance is a significant failure that affects the reliability, validity, or integrity of results or indicates a breakdown of the quality management system.

Key Characteristics

- Direct impact on test/calibration results
- Evidence of systemic failure (not isolated)
- Non-compliance with critical ISO requirements
- Results may be invalid or unreliable
- Requires immediate corrective action

Minor Nonconformance

A minor nonconformance is a deviation that does not significantly affect the validity of results and is typically isolated or administrative in nature.

Key Characteristics

- No immediate impact on **result accuracy**
- **Isolated incident**, not systemic
- Does not compromise **overall system effectiveness**
- Still requires correction, but not urgent escalation

Sources may include but not limited to:

- Observation during routine preparation, or testing work, or supervision
- Internal audits
- Stability/homogeneity test failures
- Customer complaints
- Out-of-spec test results
- Incorrect CoA's or labelling errors

5. Initial Actions

- Immediately halt use of the affected PT, RM/CRM, or analysis or process step.
- Label the product or isolate the equipment with "NON-CONFORMING" tags.
- Notify Management.
- Use SANAS F03-09 non-conformance, corrective action, and clearance report form, root cause analysis form AS001MF, AS004MF, Brainstorming form to document the process of non-conforming work, and AS009MF for additional space (ONLY USED WHERE NECESSARY).

6. Documentation

The process of opening, processing and closing a non-conformance shall document the following:

- SANAS F03-09, which documents the following:
  - Date of detection
  - Unique NCW ID
  - Area /scope assessed/affected
  - Responsible person & assessor
  - Detailed observation of the non-conformance
  - Root cause analysis linked to form AS004MF
  - Corrective action taken, Corrective action verified/cleared and follow up on next assessment.
  - Given the NCW rises from a customer complaint, the lab shall send an acknowledgement email.

ADDED:

- Root cause analysis form (AS001MF)
- Brainstorming form (AS004MF)
- Evidence of implementation
- Additional Space for NC's (AS009MF)

AzurESky	MANAGEMENT OF NON-CONFORMING WORK		
	Document no: ASMF7.17		
	Compiled by:	Sifiso Nyambi - Laboratory Manager	
	Approved by:	Nonhlanhla Msibi - Operations Manager	

7. Corrective Actions

- Where necessary, changes to the management system (procedures, work instructions, risk registers, or controls) shall be implemented to prevent recurrence of the non-conformance.
- Appropriate corrective actions shall be proportional to the risk and impact of the non-conforming work (which will be determined when there is recurrence of NC and/or during internal audits).
- All corrective actions shall be traceable to the identified root cause.

Where necessary:

- Ensure notification of customers and recall CRM's/RM's and certificates and documentation within an appropriate period. This also means that any tested samples which can have a significant impact on the operations of customers shall be relayed to the client.
- PT & COA's reports already sent to participants are recalled or disregarded following the correct amendment process defined in procedure 7.8 Reporting of results.

8. Follow-Up and Closure

Upon closure of the non-conformances and taking into consideration the nature of the non-conformance(major or minor) which informs of the duration of the follow up, the follow-up on the non-conformances will include a review of the effectiveness of actions to address the NCW and if within the specified time frame a recurrence happens, then management has to perform a risk analysis of the non-conformance using document 8.5 Actions to address risks & opportunities.

Management reserves the right to perform an immediate risk assessment for any NC deemed to be of high impact and needing immediate assessment.

- Verify the corrective action eliminated or mitigated the issue
- Retest or recharacterize RM/CRM/sample batch if necessary
- Update NCW register and archive all records securely

Effective date	Rev status	Next review date
04/2026	04	042029

9. Timelines

- Major NCs shall be addressed within 7 days from the time of detection.
- Minor NCs shall be addressed within 7-14 days from the time of detection.

ADDED:

- Effectiveness of corrective actions for **Major NCs** shall be reviewed within **1 to 3 months (monitoring period)**, depending on the nature and risk of the non-conformance.
- Effectiveness of corrective actions for **Minor NCs** shall be reviewed within **3 to 6 months (monitoring period)** after implementation.
- Where justified by the nature of the non-conformance (e.g. long-term stability, trend monitoring), extended review periods may be defined and documented.

10. Record Retention

- NCW records must be stored for a minimum of 10 years, linked to batch records.
- Include them in management review for trend analysis.

ADDED
Corrective action records shall be available for verification during internal audits and external assessments.

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Updated NC Register

NC No.	Date Identified(Part 1)	Assesor/Inspector/Expert		Description of Non-Conformity (What went wrong?/Part 1)	Reference Document/ Clause	Corrective Action Taken(Part 3)	Impact Assessment (Major / Minor?)	Root Cause Analysis (Why it happened)	Date Closed(Part 4)	Follow-up Date(Part 5)	Effectiveness Verification (Outcome)	Verified By (Name & Date)	Status (Open / Closed)
NC01	07/04/2026	N. Chiliza	1	The platform scale used for sample preparation is moved around when sample is weighed at different stages posing an accuracy risk	ISO 17025 Clause 7.4/5.4	An internal memo was sent out outlining the factors that influence proper functioning of the balance and how it affects accuracy. The memo prohibits the movement of balances without authorisation from management	Major	Lack of understanding the importance of job	13/04/2026				Open
NC02	07/04/2026	N. Chiliza	1	Both vessel and lid were placed in the oven contrary to procedure AS00MW where only the open vessel should go to the oven and the lid to be placed in the desiccator	ISO 17025 7.2	Session held with personnel reminding them of the proper way to carry out IM analysis.	Major	Negligence & Oversight	08/04/2026				Open
NC04	08/04/2026	N. Chiliza	1	Control chart (27/08/25 - 03/10/2025) had ten points below the mean and no action was taken. Rules presented for control charts aren't part of the system	ISO 17025 7.7	AS001V procedure was updated and control charts interpretations and references were included. Staff was also informed on the changes of the procedure	Major	Negligence & lack of processes defined	13/04/2026				Open
NC06	08/04/2026	N. Chiliza	1	No method validation for total moisture	ISO 17025 7.1	Conduct analysis from competent personnel and also do method validation report for TM.	Major	Inadequate planning	14/04/2026				Open
NC07	08/04/2026	N. Chiliza	1	Although CAB is participating in the PT for Sample preration and total moisture this is not included in the Lab PT plan QM S-AS001	ISO 17025 7.7	PT plan was revised to include sample prep and TM within their frequency of participation in the plan.	Major	Oversight	13/04/2026				Open
AB01	08/04/2026	A.Bougart	1	The impartiality policy ASFM 4.2 was not signed by personnel acknowledging the policy	ISO 17025 8.4.2	Session was held with personnel to communicate the implementation of the impartiality policy ASMF 4.2	Major	Oversight	15/04/2026				Open
AB04	08/04/2026	A.Bougart	1	Risk for impartiality for financial dependance was done with the solution that an alt company number will be used to mitigate risk, however the alt number was not shared with clients.	ISO 17025 4.1.4	Formal memo was issued to management confirming the only approved number for client communication	Major	Oversight	13/04/2026				Open
AB05	08/04/2026	A.Bougart	1	ASDP001 does not include the testing coal samples of client but does include PT provision scheme and CRM production.	ISO 17025 5.3	ASDP001 was updated to include testing activities for clients within the defined scope of the lab's activities	Major	Oversight	15/04/2026				Open
AB06	08/04/2026	A.Bougart	1	ASMF 8.7.3 was not used for NC01 as per ASMF 7.16.5. The lab's NCW register has incorrect closing dates and NC dates.	ISO 17025 7.10	System simplication, procedural update and staff training	Major	System redundancy and ambiguity, Communication and audit retrival and register interpretation	15/04/2026				Open
AB08	08/04/2026	A.Bougart	1	ASMF 7.17 had a revision 01 but no evidance that revision 00 was made obsolete. All personnel had access to the system with editable versions accessible.	ISO 17025 8.3.2	ASMF 7.17 was immediately corrected. Implementation of access control and system improvement	Major	Incomplete document lifecycle procedure, Inadequate IT permissions management and Administrative oversight	16/04/2026				Open
AB09	08/04/2026	A.Bougart	1	ASMF 7.17 was amended and no changes documented from version 0 to version 1	ISO 17025 8.3.2	Immediate correction and review of ASMF 7.17 was done. Staff was trained	Major	Inadequate verification step and procedural misinterpretation	17/04/2026				Open

mber of NCs: 11

Note: If there is no recurrence of the same NC after the follow-up period has ended, the EFFECTIVENESS VERIFICATION shall state "EFFECTIVE". If there is a recurrence, the EFFECTIVE VERIFICATION shall state NOT EFFECTIVE, PERFORM RISK ASSESSMENT

AzurESky	ATTENDANCE REGISTER		
	Document no:	Version:	Page:
	ASMF 17043-8.4.1	0	1
	Compiled by:	Sifiso Nyambi - Laboratory Manager	
	Approved by:	Nonhlanhla Msibi - Operations Manager	
Date:	16/04/26		
Chair:	TMJ Mapoya	Scribe	
Subject:	Awareness on updates/changes to Procedure 7.17		
Absent:			

Present	Cell Number	Designation	Signature	Email address
TMJ Mapoya	076 485 0692	Lab Supervisor		tshepo@azuresky.it.com
SB Nyambi	072 174 1852	Lab Manager		Sifiso.bernard.nyambi@t.com.
K. Maleka	071 724 9031	Lab analyst		Keitumetse@azuresky.it.com
NN Hongwane	072 373 2558	Lab Analyst		nosipho@azuresky.it.com.
N. Msibi	083 786 8149	Ops Manager		nonhlanhla@azuresky.it.com